

Drawing Basics

Drawing is an immediate and accessible way to communicate through imagery. The desire to draw is as natural as the desire to talk. As children, we draw long before we learn to read and write. In fact, making letter forms is a kind of drawing—especially when we first learn to “write.” Some of us continue to enjoy drawing; others return to drawing as adults. Those who no longer draw probably came to believe they did not draw well enough to suit themselves or others. Yet drawing is a learned process. It is a way of seeing and communicating, a way of paying attention.

In the most basic sense, to draw means to pull, push, or drag a marking tool across a surface to leave a line or mark.

Most people working in the visual arts use drawing as an important tool for visual thinking—for recording and developing ideas.



“Inverted” Grip



**“Tip Heavy”
Overhand Grip**



“Paint brush” Grip



Traditional Grip

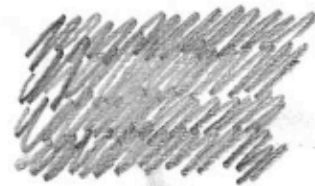


**“Drumstick”
Grip**

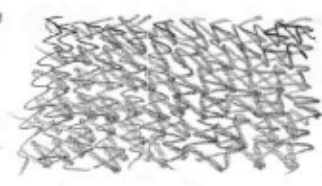


Basic Marks

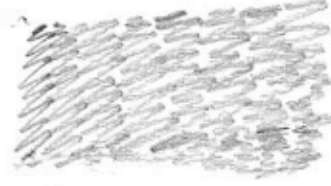
SOFT PENCIL MARKS



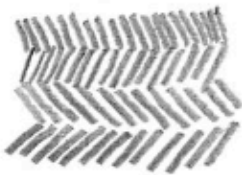
2B: Horizontal rows of scribbled shading.



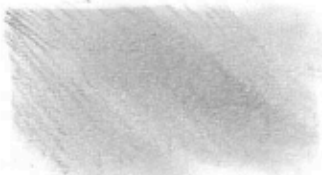
Scribbled lines implying a knitted texture and shadow.



Vertical scribble, creating a soft texture and shading.



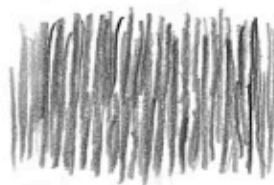
3B: Heavy herringbone texture.



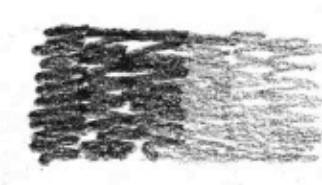
Smudged tone (with the finger) to create atmosphere.



Random mark making implying a rough texture.



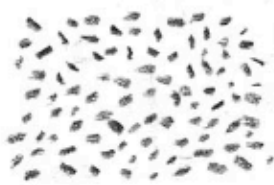
4B: A pushed zigzag line using the side of the pencil.



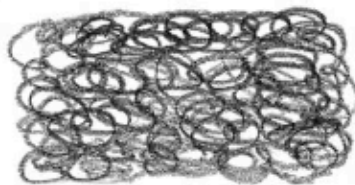
Rows of vertical scribble, progressing from dark to light.



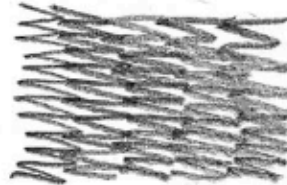
Regular dashes of tone.



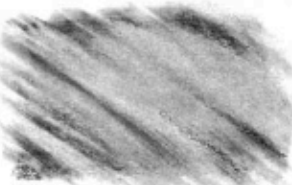
5B: Irregular dots, creating an implied texture, perhaps a gravel path.



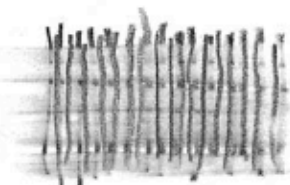
Woolly scribble creating a textured surface.



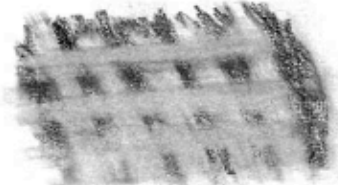
Open zigzag lines create tone and texture.



6B: Layer of graphite rubbed diagonally to create atmosphere.



Vertical lines rubbed horizontally and then vertical lines drawn over the top to create a woven texture.



Tone rubbed vertically and then horizontally to create a woven texture.

HARD PENCIL MARKS

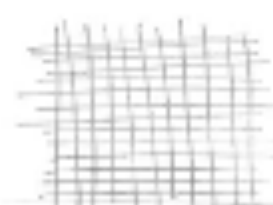
NB: I have not given you examples of mark making with HB or 7H to 9H pencils.



61. Vertical lines



Horizontal lines



Vertical and horizontal



51. Diagonal lines, sloping left



Diagonal lines with left and right emphases



Diagonals with horizontal and vertical lines



41. A zigzag line.



Horizontal line achieved with the side of the point.



A combination of the previous marks.



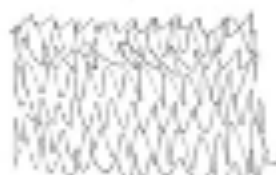
31. Dragging the side of the pencil horizontally in rows of zigzag lines.



Spaced dragged dashes.



Herring-bone pattern.



21. Rows of regularly textured lines



Horizontal and vertical lines, producing a knitted texture



Wavy horizontal lines

Basic Shapes

Hatching



Crosshatching



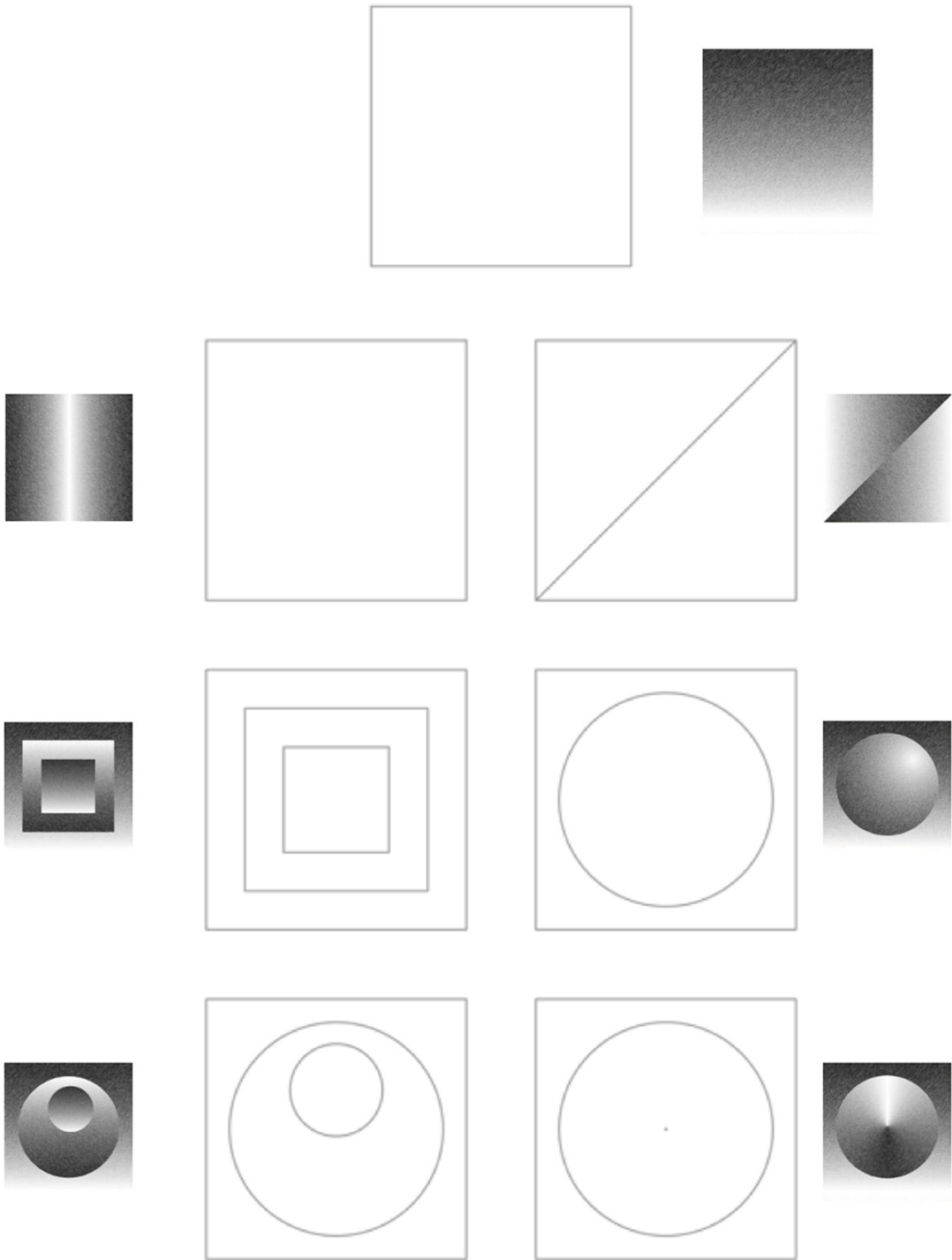
Stippling



Blending



Value and Tone



Color

BRATIX.COM

COLOR MIXING GUIDE

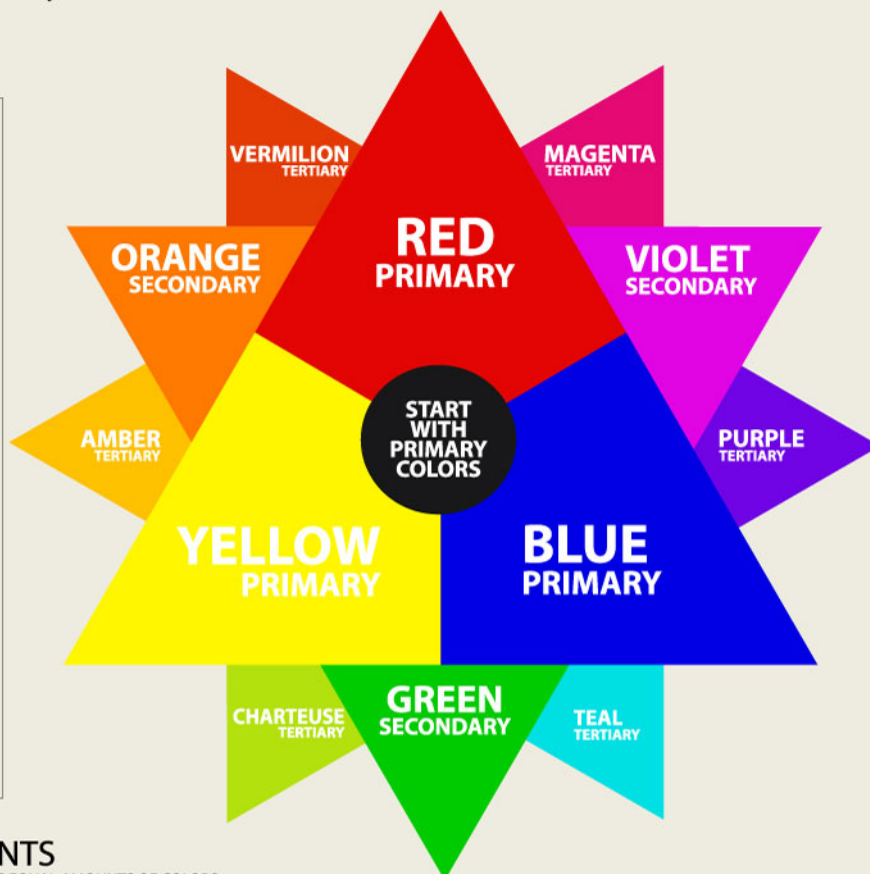
FOR ARTISTS, DESIGNERS AND PAINTERS

RYB

(RED, YELLOW, BLUE) IS A SET OF PRIMARY COLORS IN SUBTRACTIVE COLOR MIXING SYSTEM. THEY ARE MOST COMMONLY USED IN ART, DESIGN AND PAINTING.

IN THE 18TH CENTURY, THE RYB BECAME THE FOUNDATION OF THE COLOR VISION THEORIES AS THE FUNDAMENTAL SENSORY QUALITIES THAT ARE BLENDED IN THE PERCEPTION OF ALL PHYSICAL COLORS AND EQUALLY IN THE PHYSICAL MIXTURE OF PIGMENTS OR DYES.

IN SUBTRACTIVE COLOR MIXING, LIKE PAINT, ALL THE COLORS COMBINED CREATE BLACK.

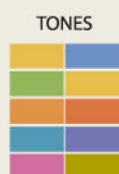


EQUAL AMOUNTS

COLORS PRODUCED BY MIXING EQUAL AMOUNTS OF COLORS
* EQUAL MEANS THAT RATIOS ARE ALWAYS THE SAME 1:1



MIX WITH WHITE TO CREATE TINTS



MIX WITH GRAY TO CREATE TONES



MIX WITH BLACK TO CREATE SHADES

PROPORTIONAL AMOUNTS

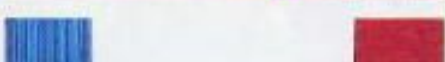
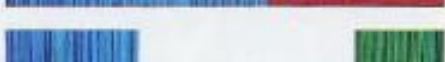
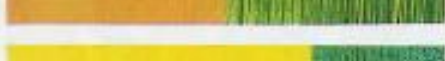
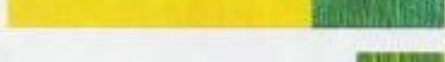
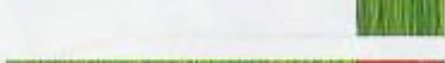
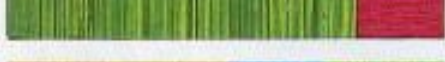
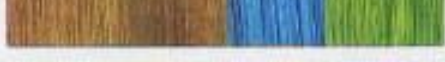
COLORS PRODUCED BY MIXING PROPORTIONAL AMOUNTS OF COLORS
* PROPORTIONAL MEANS A VARIATION OF THE QUANTITIES OF CONSTANT MULTIPLE, FOR EXAMPLE 1:2.



COLOR SPECTRUM



Formula is based on 10 parts as a whole mix.

	BRIGHT ORANGE		8 CY + 2 CR
	FLESH		3 YO + 6 TW + 1 CR
	PEACH		2 CY + 7 TW + 1 CR
	BRICK RED		6 CY + 2 CR + 1 BU + 1 AC
	LAVENDER		2 PB + 6 TW + 2 AC
	PURPLE		6 PB + 4 AC
	CERULEAN BLUE		3 PB + 5 TW + 2 PG
	ULTRAMARINE BLUE		8 PB + 2 AC
	GOLDEN GREEN		5 YO + 5 SG
	LIME GREEN		7 CY + 3 PG
	MINT GREEN		8 TW + 2 SG
	OLIVE GREEN		8 SG + 2 AC
	BLACK GREEN		5 BU + 2 PB + 3 SG
	BURNT SIENNA		5 YO + 5 AC
	RAW SIENNA		6 BU + 4 CR
	TAN		5 YO + 4 TW + 1 AC
	BEIGE		7 TW + 3 BU
	GRAY		7 TW + 3 VDB
	IVORY BLACK		6 VDB + 3 PB + 1 CR
	BLACK — cool		6 PG + 4 AC

Extended Grip

The extended tripod grip is a variation of the tripod grip. The tripod grip is still used, but you will hold the pencil at bit further at the end or near the tip that has the eraser. Because your control is at the other end of the pencil, small movements of your hand make larger effects on the other end.



Underhand Grip



Another variation of the tripod grip is the underhand grip, there is also an underhand grip. This is another relaxed way of holding a pencil. This grip is best suited for broad sketching. The pencil is positioned in a 'V' with the middle and index finger controlling the movement. Using this type of grip will help you make firm lines and small linear details.

Overhand Grip

For sketching, most artists use the overhand grip. The aim of the overhand grip is to have a relaxed grip on the pencil but not too relaxed that the grip would not be secure.

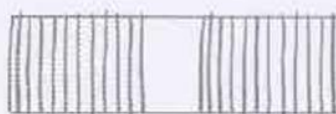
You can draw sitting or standing, make sure that your arm has full range movement. Shading is easier with the overhand grip.



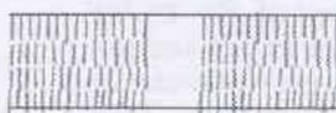
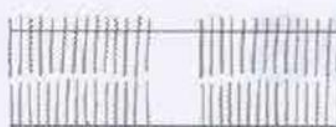
MAKING STROKES CONSISTENT

There are four keys to maintaining consistency in your strokes: spacing, size, weight, and direction. Your strokes need not be perfect or identical but should be uniform enough to convincingly convey cohesion. To develop consistency, do not rush your strokes. Focus on drawing at a steady, controlled pace.

Spacing



Size



Weight

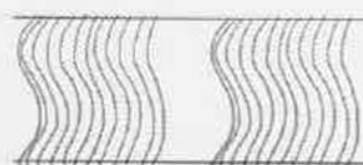
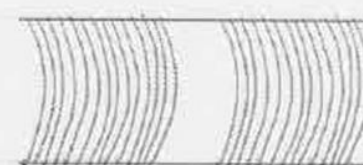
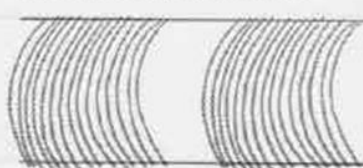


Direction



CURVED LINES

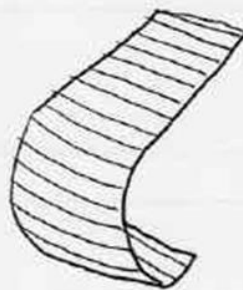
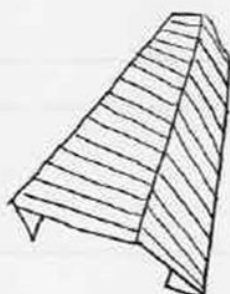
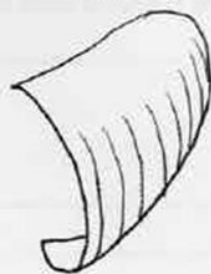
Depending on whether you are right- or left-handed you will be more comfortable drawing some lines more than others. You may also find that drawing various lines require different adjustments. It is okay to make the adjustments you feel necessary. Loosen your grip, shift your seating, or rotate the book if you need to.



Without Consistency

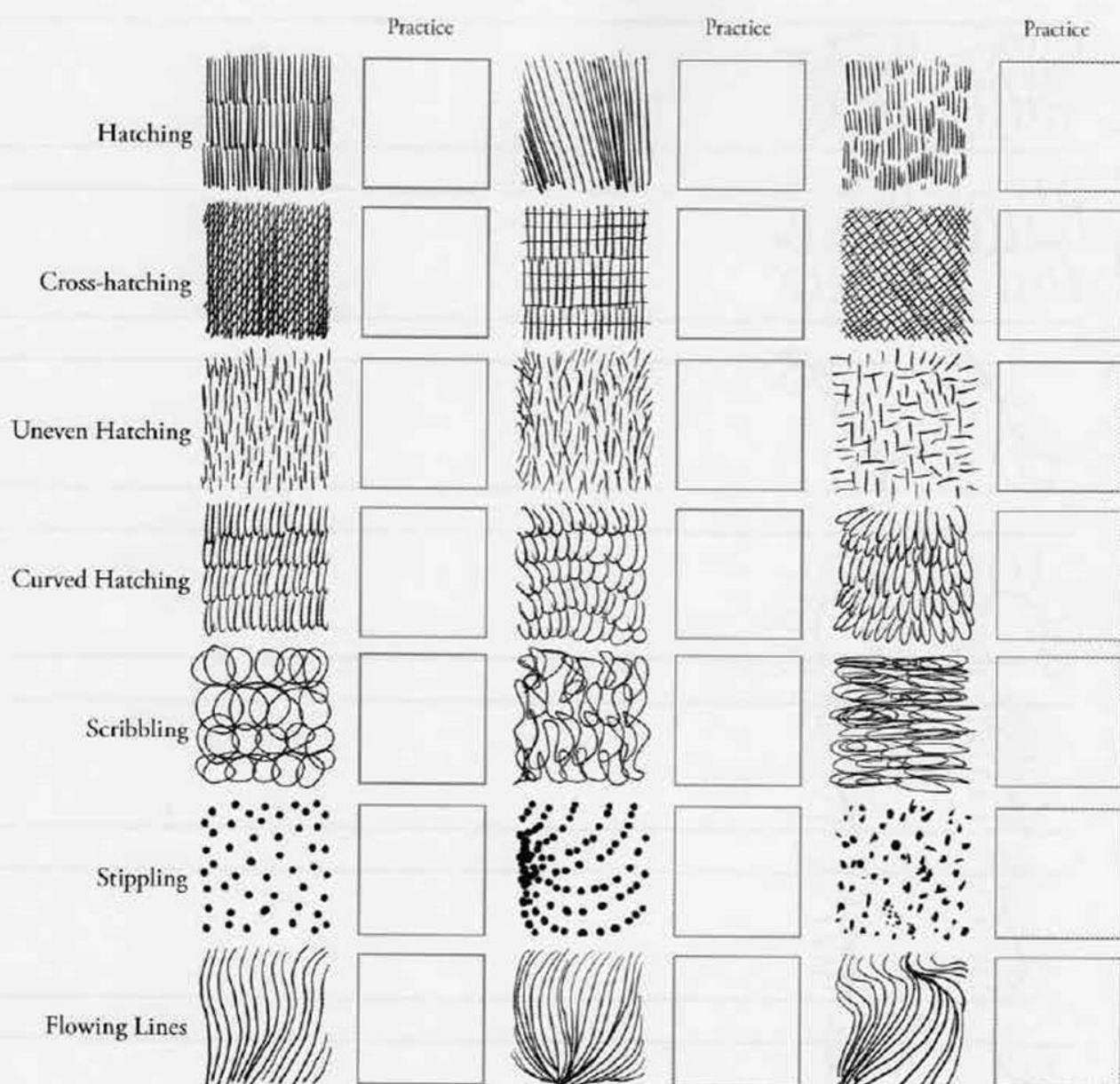
With Consistency

Practice



THE BASIC STROKES

These are the main types of strokes used to create most pen and ink drawings. Note that each may appear in a variety of forms. Practice until you are sufficiently proficient with each of them and are able to recognize and distinguish their use in works of other artists.



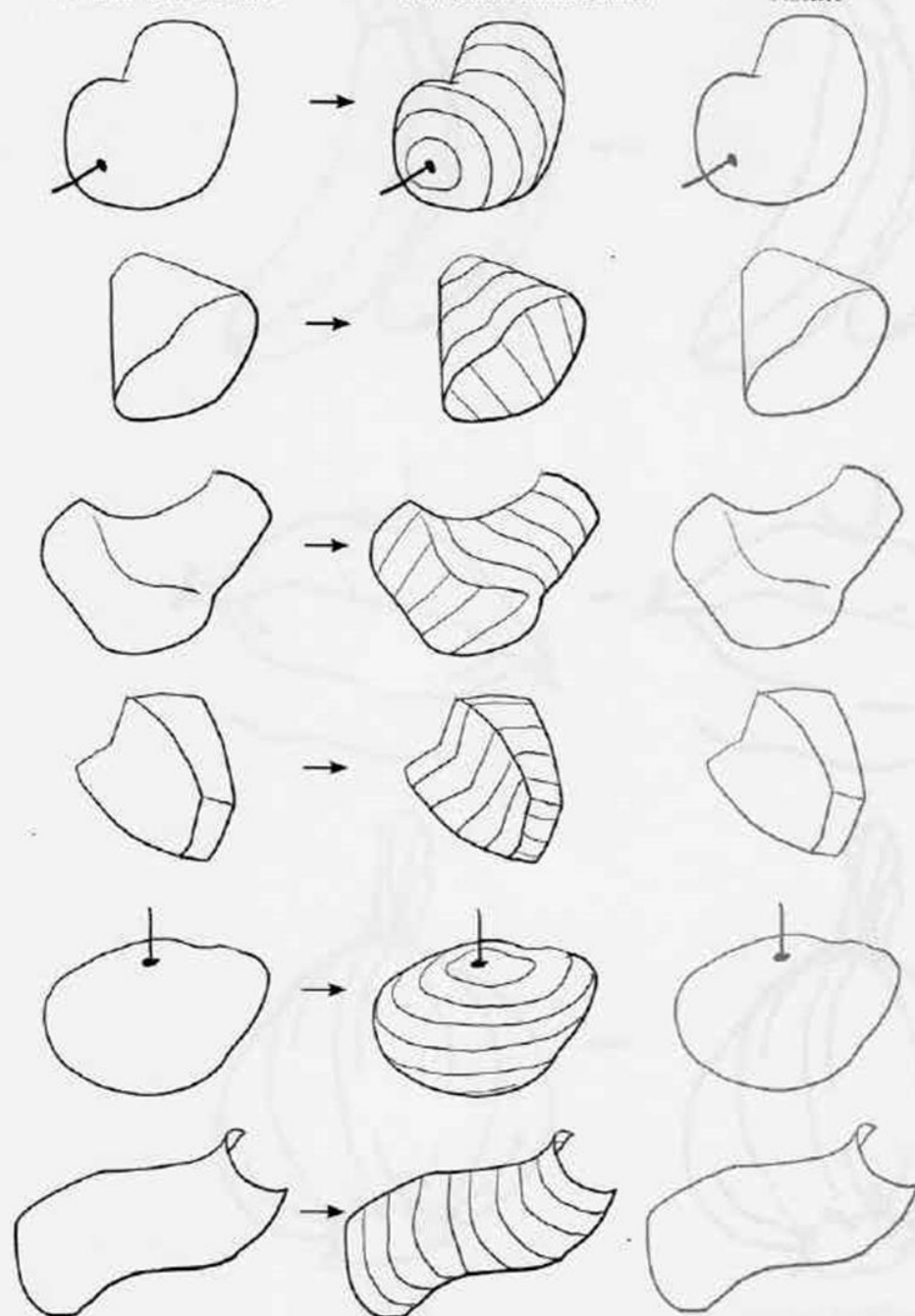
CROSS-CONTOUR LINES

Cross-contour lines are a critical aspect of pen and ink drawing because they can convey so much information about a subject. They describe form, texture, value, mass, light and shadow, and more. Try to envision the three-dimensional shape of subjects before drawing them.

No Cross-Contour Lines

With Cross-Contour Lines

Practice





Hatching



Cross-hatching



Uneven Hatching



Curved Hatching



Scribbling



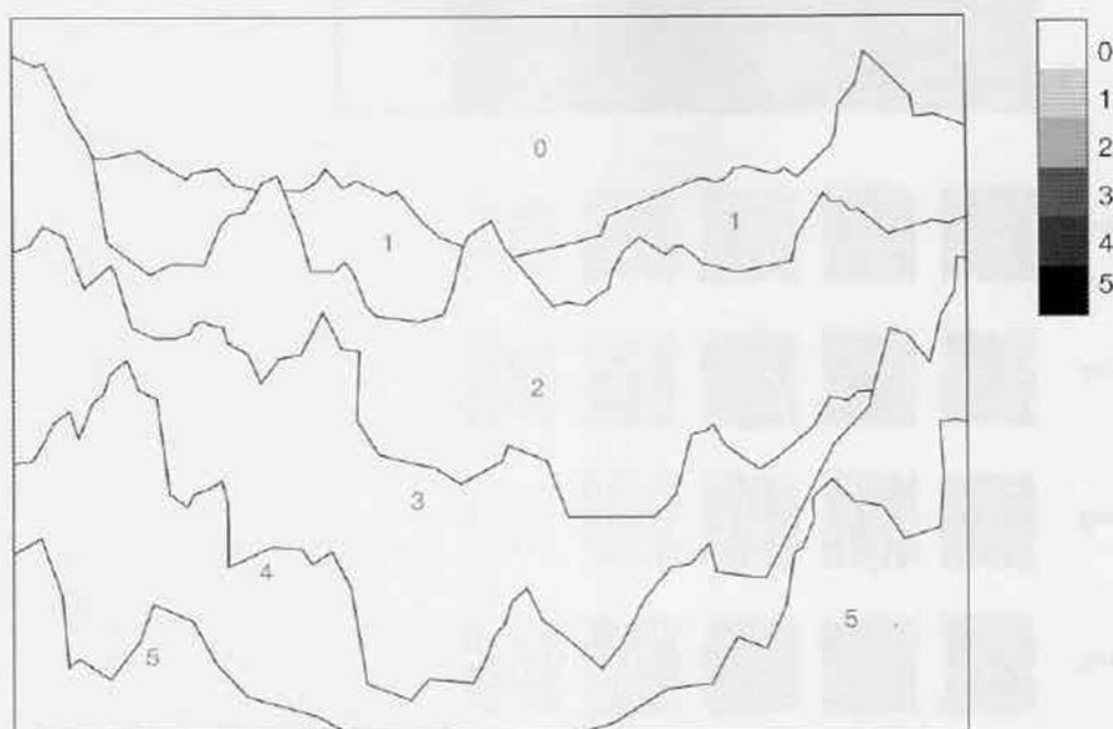
Stippling



Flowing Lines



The challenge of this exercise is to maintain the designated value within each section, while working within the irregularities in the shape of each.



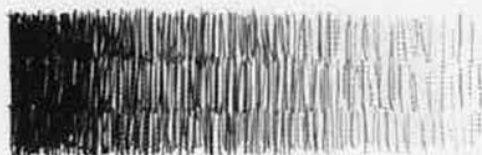
BLENDING VALUES

Smoothly blending values is an essential skill in drawing. The applications range from modeling three-dimensional forms to conveying depth, mass, and more. When blending values, leave the deepest and lightest values for last and focus on the middle value transitions first.

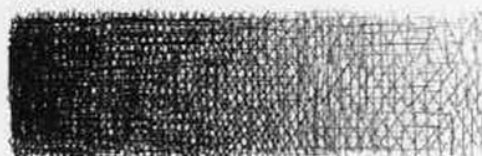


Practice

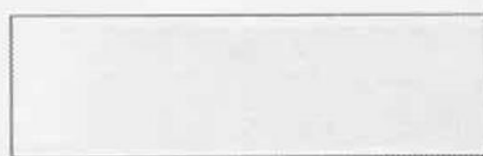
Hatching



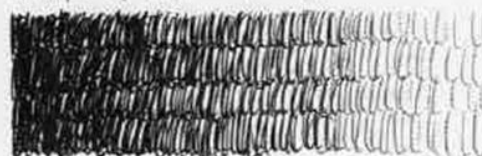
Cross-hatching



Uneven Hatching



Curved Hatching



Scribbling



Stippling

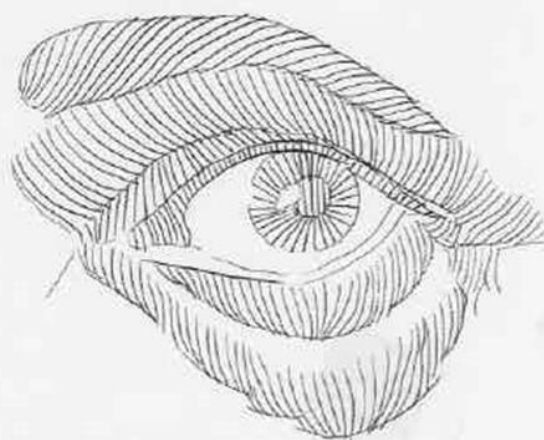


Flowing Lines

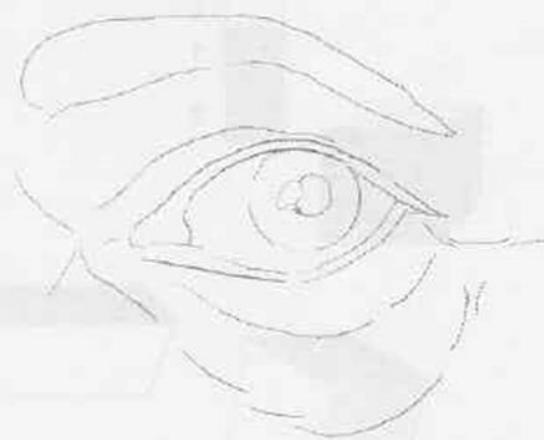


In both drawings the overall value conveyed by the strokes stays the same, although their direction changes to follow the cross-contour of the forms. Try to master this technique. It is critical to your success in pen and ink drawing. The goal is to keep your lines consistent regardless of the area they describe.

Example



Practice



TEXTURE PATTERNS

All textures are based on some type of pattern. With pen and ink drawing, dots, lines, shapes, and values can be used as your building blocks. Combined with the five variations, these building blocks can be used to create hundreds of captivating textures.

Stipple Patterns



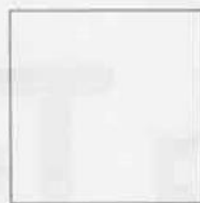
Practice



Practice



Line Patterns



Shape Patterns



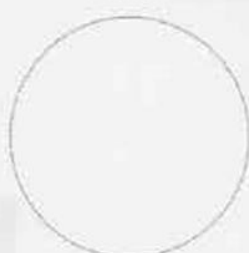
Combined Patterns



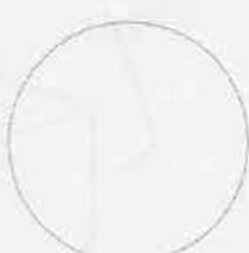
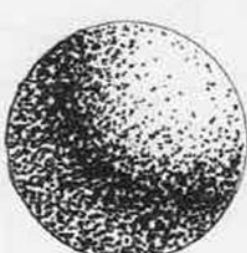
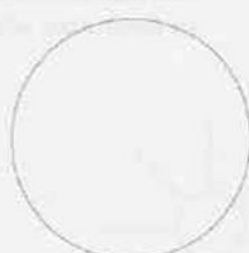
Combined Patterns

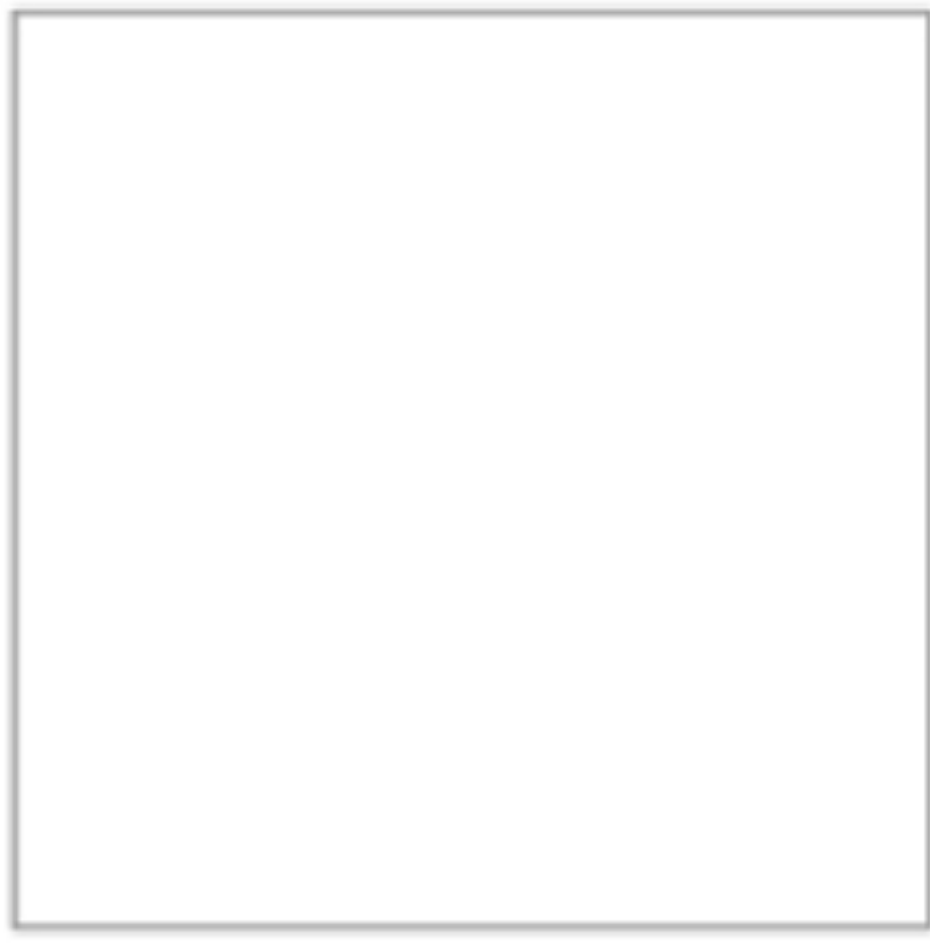


Practice

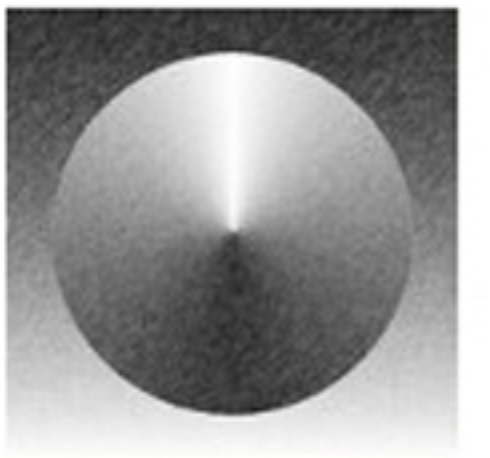
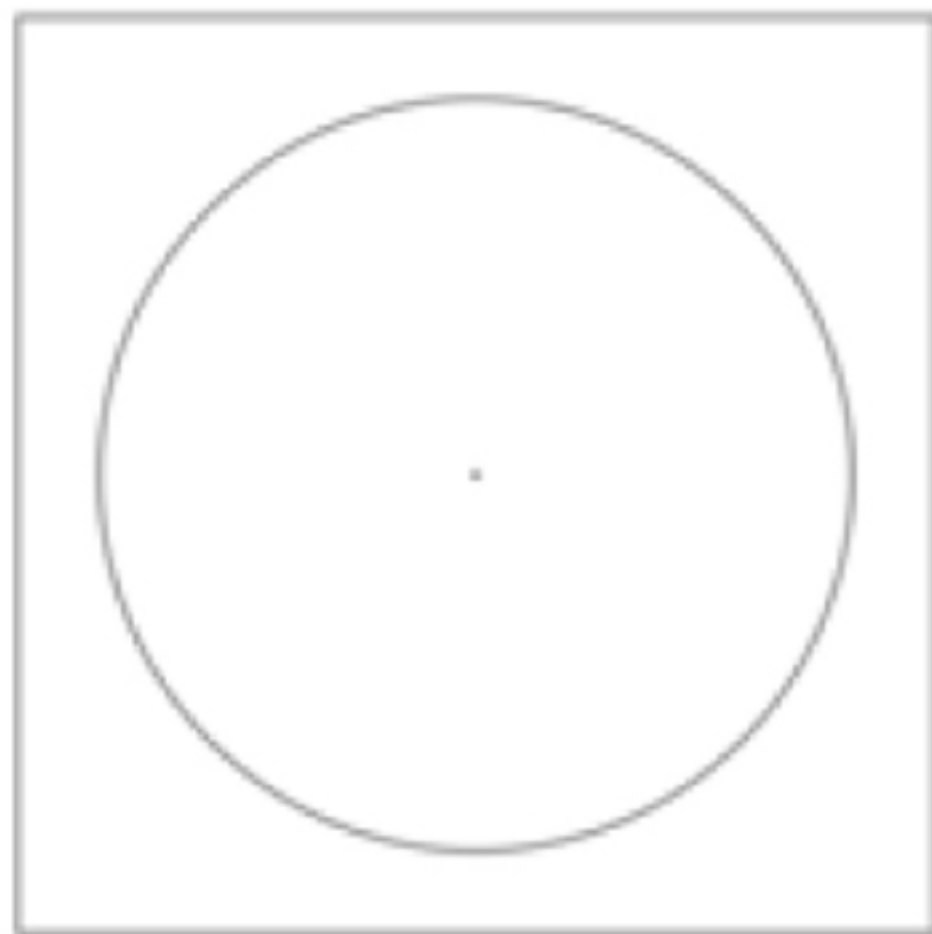
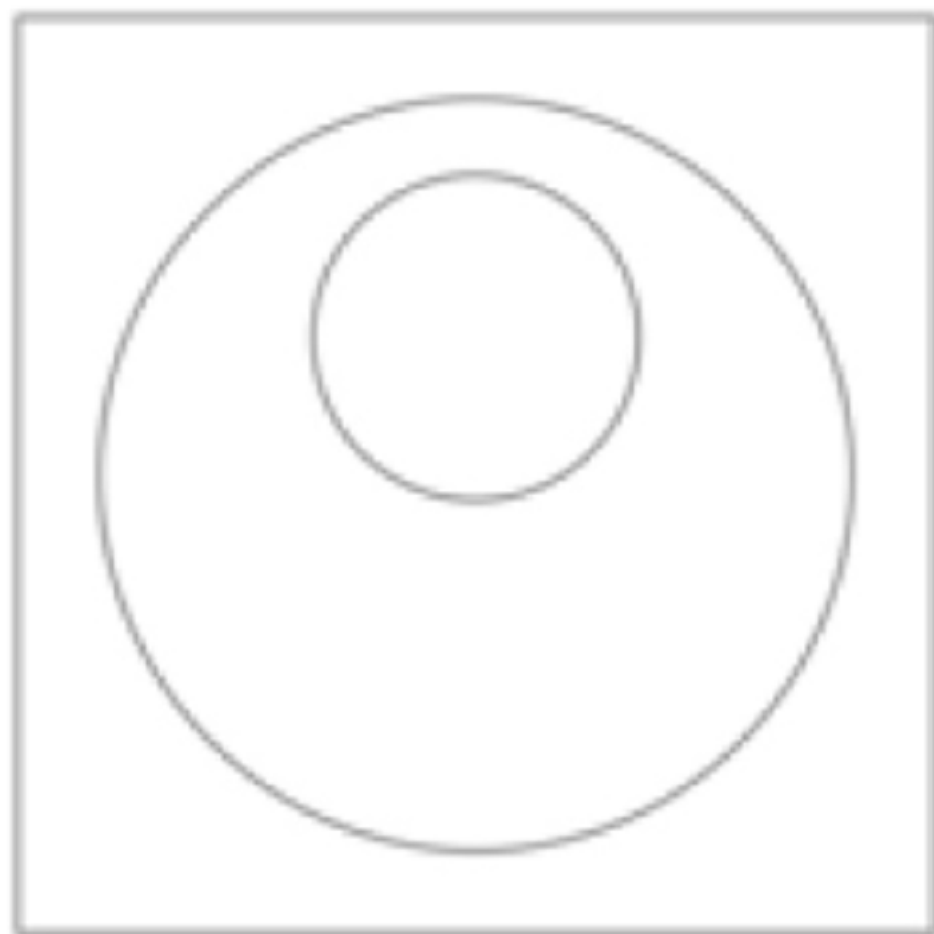
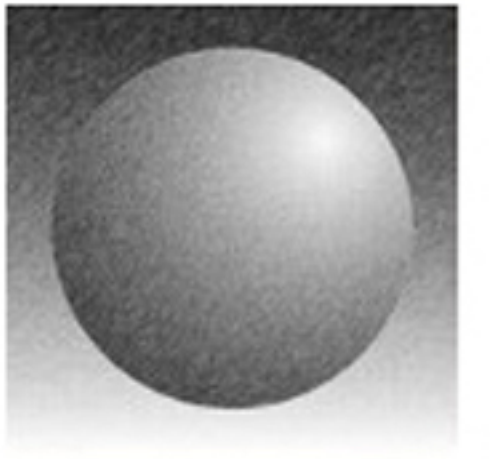
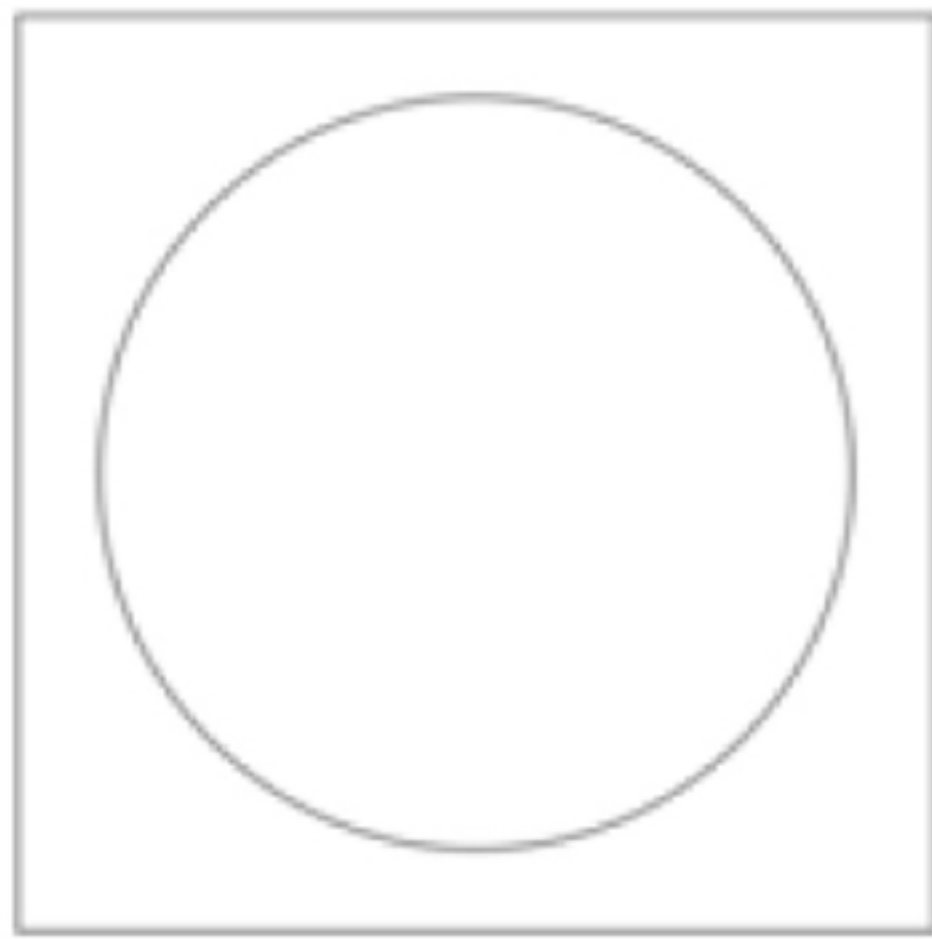
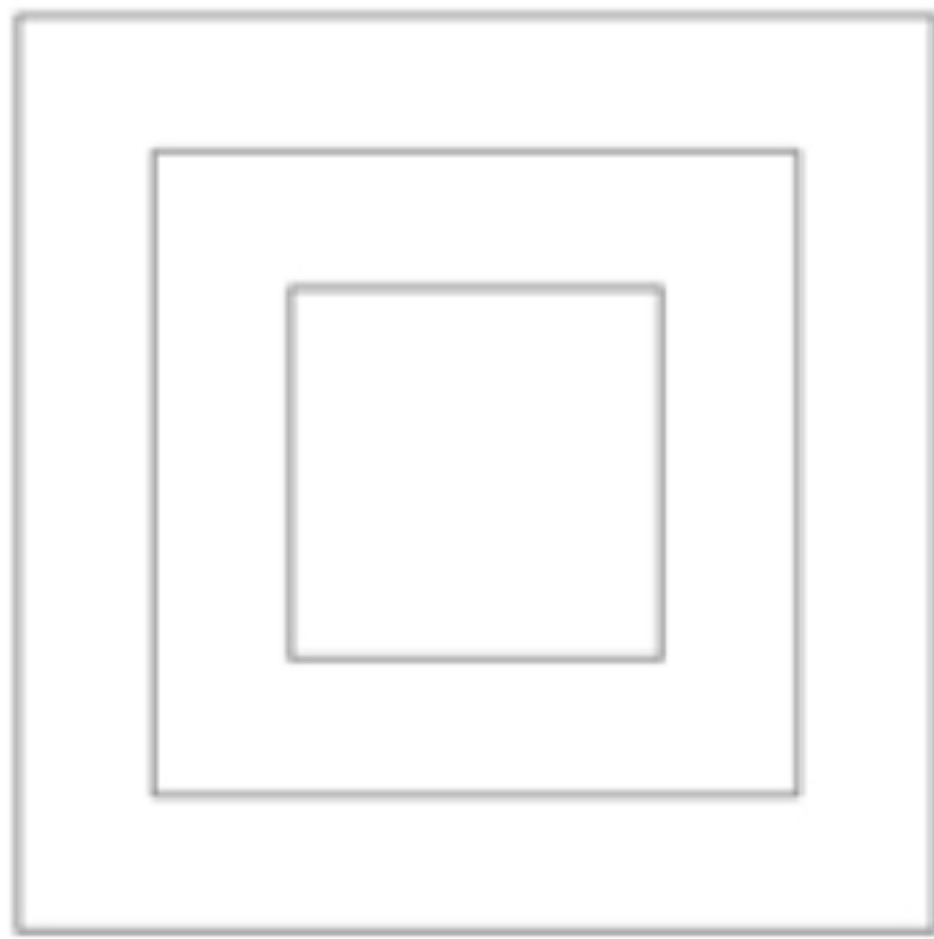
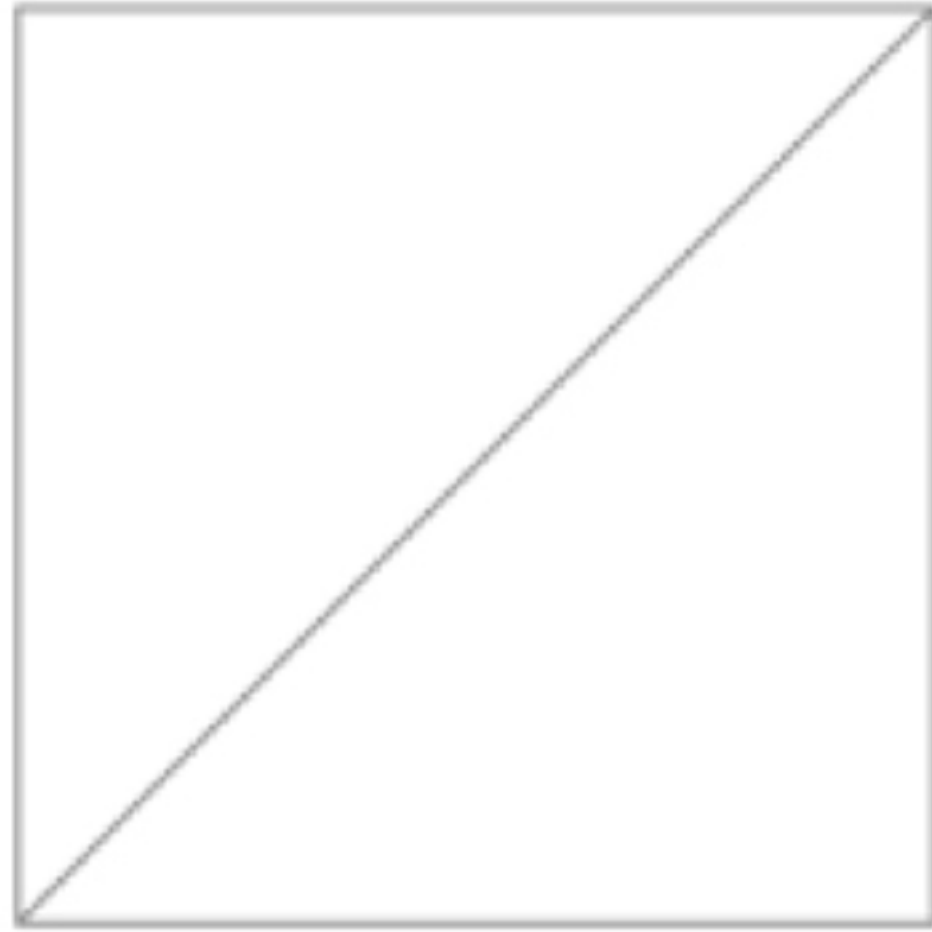
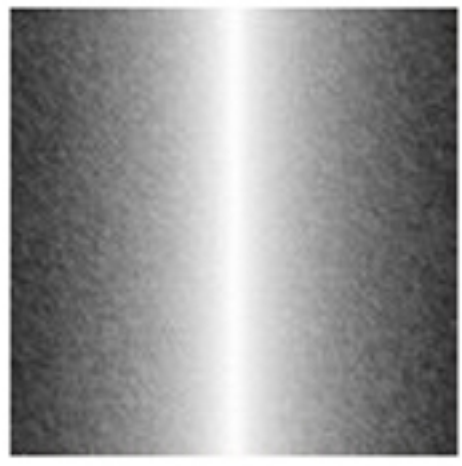


Practice





Source: <https://www.shutterstock.com>



Source: <https://www.shutterstock.com>